

Exploro OS — Cost Per User Analysis

1. Tools Used (Actual Stack)

Tool	Type	Cost
DeepSeek (deepseek-v4-flash)	LLM — chat + web search query rewriting	\$0.14/1M input, \$0.28/1M output
Serper.dev	Google web search API	\$1.00/1K queries (Starter), \$0.50/1K (Scale)
Supabase	Database, Auth, Storage	\$25/mo (Pro) or \$299/mo (Team) fixed
Vercel	Hosting, serverless API routes	\$20/mo (Pro) fixed
Stripe	Payment processing (US)	2.9% + \$0.30 per transaction
Lemon Squeezy	Payment processing (MX/LATAM)	5% + \$0.50 per transaction
WhatsApp Business API	Messaging channel (Team+ only)	~\$0.008/template msg (MX), service msgs free
Calendly	Scheduling (Team+ only)	\$10/seat (Standard), \$16/seat (Teams)
Google OAuth (Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Meet)	Integrations	Free
Microsoft Graph (Outlook)	Email/calendar	Free
Telegram Bot API	Messaging (Enterprise)	Free
pdf-parse, mammoth, xlsx, JSZip	Document parsing	Free (open source)

2. Fixed Costs (Platform-Level, Shared Across All Users)

These are paid monthly regardless of how many users are on the platform:

Item	Cost/Month	Notes
Supabase Pro	\$25	Up to 100K auth users, 8 GB DB, 100 GB storage
Vercel Pro	\$20	1 TB bandwidth, 1K GB-hrs serverless
Domain + DNS	~\$1	Annual amortized
Total Fixed	~\$46/mo	Same whether you have 1 or 10,000 users

At 1,000 users: fixed cost per user = **\$0.046/mo** — negligible.

3. Variable Costs (Per User, Scales With Usage)

Item	How It Scales	Solo Cost/Mo	Team Cost/Mo	Enterprise Cost/Mo
DeepSeek tokens	Per chat message	\$0.52	\$1.15	\$2.25
Serper web search	Per web-search-enabled message (2.5 calls each)	\$0.45	\$1.13	\$1.20
WhatsApp	Per template message (service msgs free)	\$0 (not included)	\$0.16	\$0.40
Calendly	Per seat, fixed monthly subscription	\$0 (not included)	\$10.00	\$16.00
Payment processing	% of transaction	\$1.17 (Stripe) / \$2.00 (Lemon)	\$1.75 / \$3.00	\$3.20 / \$5.50
Supabase (variable portion)	Storage per user	~\$0.03	\$0.05	\$5.98 (Team tier)
Vercel (variable portion)	Serverless invocations	~\$0.02	\$0.04	\$2.00
Multimodal (Qwen2.5-VL + DeepSeek)	Per image message (optional add-on)	+\$0.16	+\$0.27	+\$0.43

4. Cost Summary by Plan

SOLO — \$30/month

Category	Cost (Stripe)	Cost (Lemon Squeezy)
Fixed (amortized @ 1K users)	\$0.05	\$0.05
Variable — AI (DeepSeek + Serper)	\$0.97	\$0.97
Variable — Payment	\$1.17	\$2.00
Variable — Other	\$0.02	\$0.02
Total Cost/User	\$2.21	\$3.04
Revenue	\$30.00	\$30.00
Margin	\$27.79 (93%)	\$26.96 (90%)

TEAM — \$50/seat/month

Category	Cost (Stripe)	Cost (Lemon Squeezy)
Fixed (amortized @ 1K users)	\$0.05	\$0.05
Variable — AI (DeepSeek + Serper)	\$2.28	\$2.28
Variable — Calendly	\$10.00	\$10.00
Variable — WhatsApp	\$0.16	\$0.16
Variable — Payment	\$1.75	\$3.00
Variable — Other (infra)	\$0.09	\$0.09
Total Cost/Seat	\$14.33	\$15.58
Revenue	\$50.00	\$50.00
Margin	\$35.67 (71%)	\$34.42 (69%)

Without Calendly: Total = \$4.33–\$5.58, Margin = **89–91%**

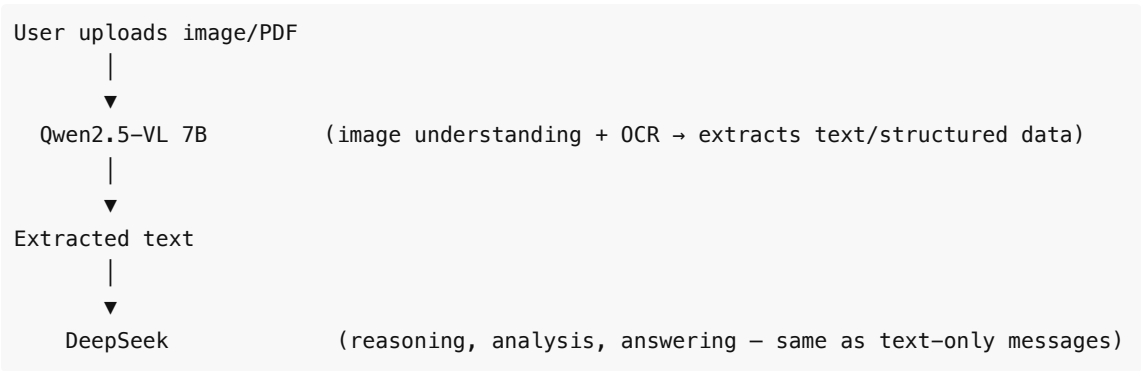
ENTERPRISE — \$100–\$150/seat/month

Category	Cost (Stripe)	Cost (Lemon Squeezy)
Fixed (Supabase Team \$299 + Vercel ~\$100, amortized @ 50 seats)	\$7.98	\$7.98
Variable — AI (DeepSeek + Serper)	\$3.45	\$3.45
Variable — Calendly	\$16.00	\$16.00
Variable — WhatsApp	\$0.40	\$0.40
Variable — Payment	\$3.20	\$5.50
Variable — Other (SSO, custom)	\$2.00	\$2.00
Total Cost/Seat	\$33.03	\$35.33
Revenue (at \$100)	\$100.00	\$100.00
Margin	\$66.97 (67%)	\$64.67 (65%)
Revenue (at \$150)	\$150.00	\$150.00
Margin	\$116.97 (78%)	\$114.67 (76%)

Without Calendly: Total = \$17.03–\$19.33, Margin at \$100 = **83–87%**

5. Multimodal (Image/PDF Upload) — Qwen2.5-VL + DeepSeek Pipeline

DeepSeek's hosted API is text-only (no vision). For image/PDF uploads, we use a two-step pipeline:



Why Qwen2.5-VL:

- Excellent OCR, document/chart/table understanding
- Open-weight (could self-host later for zero API cost)
- OpenAI-compatible API via Alibaba DashScope
- Cheapest hosted vision model available

Pricing (verified July 2026, Alibaba DashScope):

Model	Input/1M	Output/1M	Notes
Qwen2.5-VL 7B Instruct	\$0.20	\$0.20	Recommended — best value
Qwen3 VL Flash (newer)	\$0.05	\$0.40	Even cheaper input, monitor for stability
Gemini 2.5 Flash-Lite (alt)	\$0.10	\$0.40	Single-step alternative

Cost per image message (Qwen2.5-VL + DeepSeek pipeline):

- Qwen2.5-VL: image (250 tokens) + prompt (100 tokens) → extracted text (750 output tokens) = ~~***\$0.0002**~~
- DeepSeek: extracted text + user question + context → answer = **~\$0.0007** (same as current text-only)
- **Total: ~\$0.0009 per image message** (vs \$0.0007 for text-only — virtually identical)

Cost Impact if 20% of Messages Include Images

Plan	Image Messages/Mo	Extra Cost/Mo	New Total (Stripe)	New Margin %
Solo	180	+\$0.16	\$2.37	92%
Team	300	+\$0.27	\$14.60	71%
Enterprise	480	+\$0.43	\$33.46	67%

Verdict: Negligible impact (<\$0.50/user/month). Include as free feature in all plans.

6. The One-Page Summary

Plan	Price	Fixed Cost	Variable Cost	Total Cost	Margin
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Solo	\$30	\$0.05	\$2.16	\$2.21	93%
Team (w/ Calendly)	\$50	\$0.05	\$14.28	\$14.33	71%
Team (no Calendly)	\$50	\$0.05	\$4.28	\$4.33	91%
Enterprise (w/ Calendly)	\$100	\$7.98	\$25.05	\$33.03	67%
Enterprise (no Calendly)	\$100	\$7.98	\$9.05	\$17.03	83%

(All figures via Stripe. Lemon Squeezy adds ~\$0.83–\$2.30/user for VAT/tax handling.)

7. Key Takeaways

1. **Fixed costs are negligible** — \$46/mo total platform, near-zero per user at scale
2. **Calendly is the #1 cost driver** for Team/Enterprise (\$10–\$16/seat). Dropping it doubles margins
3. **DeepSeek is extremely cheap** — \$0.52–\$2.25/user, major competitive advantage
4. **Serper is the #2 variable cost** — drops 50% at scale (\$1.00 → \$0.50/1K queries)
5. **WhatsApp is nearly free** — service messages (AI replies) cost nothing
6. **Multimodal adds <\$0.50/user** — Qwen2.5-VL + DeepSeek pipeline, include free as a differentiator
7. **Trial cost: ~\$1.10/user for 15 days** — at 1,000 trials = \$1,100 total (very low CAC)

Recommendations for Mexico Launch

- **Solo at \$30:** 93% margin — room for aggressive promo pricing
- **Team at \$50:** 71% with Calendly, 91% without — consider dropping Calendly or using Free tier
- **Enterprise at \$100+:** 67% with Calendly, 83% without — don't go below \$80/seat
- **Use Lemon Squeezy for MX** (handles VAT) but push Stripe where possible (2% cheaper)

All pricing verified from official provider websites, July 2026. Based on actual codebase tools only.